MUSE VS OPENCLAW: READY-MADE OR DIY?

	Muse	OpenClaw
Who makes it	Meta Superintelligence Labs	Peter Steinberger, who joined OpenAI in February 2026; the project is now stewarded by the non-profit OpenClaw Foundation (since July 8, 2026)
Where it runs	A dedicated virtual machine per user in Meta's cloud ("Muse Secure VM")	Hardware the owner controls: laptop, home server or VPS
Licence	Proprietary	MIT open source
Safety model	A separate Sentinel agent on the same VM must approve all outbound traffic; Muse asks before sensitive actions; it keeps an audit trail	Configured by the owner; OpenClaw 2.0 ships with the sandbox off and secrets unencrypted at rest (The Register)
Your data	Meta trains on interactions by default, with an opt-out; data not shared with ad systems; encrypted 'Confidential VM' promised later in 2026	Files stay with the owner; prompts still go to the chosen model provider
Price	Free tier; Power $20 a month (500M tokens a week); Maximum $100 a month (3B tokens a week)	Free software; the owner pays for hosting and model use
India (as of Oct. 15, 2026)	Not available	Usable by anyone who installs it
Built for	Mainstream consumers who never touch a terminal	Technically confident users willing to own the risk

Table B

As for the files, he said, "Peter got those things exactly right."

'Peter' is Peter Steinberger, the Austrian developer who released OpenClaw in November 2025.

Friedman also explained how it started. After he used OpenClaw in January 2026, he ended up buying hundreds of Mac minis for the MSL team and, "lots of us fell in love with using OpenClaw (and other personal agents)." Aten's test machine, the one where he says Muse read his messages, was a Mac mini too.

Mark Zuckerberg has said Meta expects to "profit by taking a small fee from transactions".

Muse, then, is OpenClaw moved out of the passion-driven user's home, and into the commission-driven Meta's data centre.

Meta is not alone

On October 21, Anthropic opened a waitlist for Claude Duet, an agent that works on its own computer in the cloud and asks before it sends a message or makes a payment. OpenAI launched its own always-on agent, Dots, a few weeks prior to that.

How do I get started?

As of October 15, Muse was live in the US and Canada, with no date for India. These tips hold for any agent that holds your logins.

1. Audit before you ask. Muse works through connectors such as email and calendar, so open Settings, then Connectors, before the first task. Some can be set to read-only, so Muse can see your calendar but not send invites to your in-laws for the office Diwali party.

2. Give it goals with a stop line. Muse drafts a plan and pushes on unattended, so name the point where it must stop and show you, such as before it pays anyone. By default, it asks before sensitive actions like sending email, so leave that on. Read the plan before a long task runs.

3. Edit what it remembers. Muse keeps its picture of you in plain files you can open and change: Memory.md for what it has learned, Soul.md for its personality. Read Memory.md after a week and tell Muse to forget anything you do not want acted on. Deleting a chat may not delete what the agent learned from it.

4. Treat home-made tools as untrusted. Muse can build custom connectors when a service has none, and Meta's help page says it does not review them.

5. Lock down the desktop. The Mac app is where Muse meets your local files, and where its one confirmed flaw sat, so grant macOS permissions sparingly. Windows is browser-only for now.

> Meta has a Sentinel for the internet. For your agent's memory file, the only sentinel is you.

> In Muse's first fortnight on Earth, a security researcher showed how to make it work for somebody else.

Bonus tip. Turn off training if you plan to use Muse on sensitive or proprietary data. Meta trains on Muse interactions unless you opt out under Data controls.

What's next?

Meta's next step points somewhere harder to inspect. Muse Wonder, announced October 12, brings what Meta calls Active Memory, which carries what matters across conversations, and will begin powering Muse, starting with subscribers.

Add the custom connectors Muse already builds, and the memory file stops being a page you audit once. It becomes something the agent keeps rewriting, beside tools no one at Meta has reviewed. What you check in week one may not be the agent you have in month six.

Right now, somewhere in Meta's cloud, Memory.md is getting longer. Its owner can open it any time; Aten found his problem by looking. EFY

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